

HOME IMPROVEMENT

Blue denotes PPT slide

Brown – Instructions to technician

Ephesians 5:22-33 (NKJV) *“Wives, submit to your own husbands, as to the Lord. 23 For the husband is head of the wife, as also Christ is head of the church; and He is the Savior of the body. 24 Therefore, just as the church is subject to Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in everything. 25 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave Himself for her, 26 that He might sanctify and cleanse her with the washing of water by the word, 27 that He might present her to Himself a glorious church, not having spot or wrinkle or any such thing, but that she should be holy and without blemish. 28 So husbands ought to love their*

own wives as their own bodies; he who loves his wife loves himself. 29 For no one ever hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, just as the Lord does the church. 30 For we are members of His body, of His flesh and of His bones. 31 “For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh.” 32 This is a great mystery, but I speak concerning Christ and the church. 33 Nevertheless let each one of you in particular so love his own wife as himself, and let the wife see that she respects her husband.”

INTRO: Marriage is the most exciting and one of the most challenging endeavors a person can undertake and, as statistics tell us, an endeavor which by no means carries with it a guarantee of success. [More than 50% of marriages end in divorce.](#) **(Leave on screen until next slide)** We are here today to make sure we don't raise that

negative stat. It is important for each of us to make a deliberate commitment to this relationship called marriage.

According to the book, "*Passages of Marriage*" by Dr. Frank and Mary Alice Minirth, Dr. Brian and Dr. Deborah Newman, & Dr. Robert and Susan Hemfelt, there are **five passages, or distinct units in marriage: (Place on screen one at a time)**

1) Young love... First two years - A lot of energy comes built into young love. There is excitement and enthusiasm! This leads to raw, exuberant, almost unbridled energy, especially in the area of lovemaking.

2) Realistic love... Third thru tenth year - This is when the reality of building a future, the

responsibilities of parenthood, and the realities of life become very apparent.

3) Comfortable love... Eleventh thru twenty-fifth year - Careers have pretty much become a settled issue, a home has been purchased and is in the process of being paid for, the Children's education is now seeming possible, things as a rule are pretty much settling down for the family.

4) Renewing love... Twenty-sixth thru thirty-fifth year - The Children are grown, gone, and hopefully paid for! Rather than life revolving around the children, there is ample time to reacquaint yourself with your spouse. The romance that may have waned over the years can now be rekindled. Some traveling is now within reach. Retirement is the major concern,

but from here it is actually beginning to appear possible.

5) Transcendent love... Thirty-sixth year - ???

This love goes far beyond the physical, and reaches new heights in the relationship. This love can enjoy a walk in the park, or sitting on the back porch, but all it really needs is the presence of the other person. This love can endure wrinkles, cellulite, beer bellies, stretch marks, gray hair, baldness, bunions, corns, arthritis, and a lot of other maladies known to mankind and womankind! This is truly a for-better-or-worse, for richer or poorer, in sickness and in health kind of love.

Genuine love is a decision, not a feeling!

I would like for you to list five reasons you married your spouse. *(Give time for this activity)*

Now I would like for you to rate the success you feel the two of you have had in each of those areas on a scale of one to ten, one being the worst and ten being the best. *(Give time for this activity)*

Now, beside each of those five things write one way YOU (Not your spouse) could improve on each of those things! *(Give time for this activity)*

As we go along in this seminar and you think of ways YOU (Not your spouse) could improve in each of these areas, I want you to jot it down.

(Don't write this down) On a scale of 1 to 10 (1/terrible, 10/great) where would you say your marriage is overall today?

(Don't write this down) On the same scale where would you like your marriage to be eventually? If you answered this with anything but a ten you may be dismissed!

If you pay attention to, and work on the things you listed that YOU (Not your spouse) can do, you will be progressively moving your relationship to a perfect 10!

It is possible for couples to successfully live together in a pleasant relationship for a lifetime if each member is willing to work diligently at nurturing the relationship.

BUILDING BLOCKS OF A HEALTHY RELATIONSHIP

Building a healthy relationship is just what it sounds like – Work! (Nasty little four letter word)

There is no such thing as a perfect marriage or a marriage made in heaven. All marriages are created, consummated, developed, and perfected right here on earth!

The earth, not Heaven is where the success or failure of your marriage will rise or fall. The most important question I could ask, *How committed are you to your marriage?* **(Leave on screen until next slide)** No marriage can be successful or pleasant unless both partners are

committed to the relationship and are willing to do whatever is necessary to make it successful.

In music, harmony is something that takes several people doing their part and playing different roles to make the music sound beautiful. Marriage is all about two people finding their place, doing their part and running in their lane. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**
(ILL: Quartet music – Four part harmony - Horses being broken to work as a team in a harness) Ephesians 5:31 (NKJV) *“For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh.”* At it’s best this is a tedious, painful process.

How do two different and unique individuals become one? By sharing the truth about themselves with one another. No Secrets!

It is vitally important that a culture of openness be created within the marriage. A culture of openness can only be created if the following three rules are meticulously applied: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Each person should be able to share his or her likes and dislikes...
- When ones spouse shares a concern one should be careful of ones attitude, body language and facial expressions... (These things can shut off communication)
- Each person must be willing to accommodate the other as long as it does not violate a scriptural principle... (My wedding ring say's in Hebrew – “*I am my beloved's*

and my beloved is mine” – When you get married you are no longer your own)

When both members of a couple are committed to telling the truth about what they are thinking and feeling, the amount of “unknown” in a relationship is minimized and harmony is maximized.

Sharing the truth with your partner is risky business. Not knowing the truth does not change it - Rather it simply means that you cannot be helped by it.

Marriage is a developmental process, not an event that became complete when you fell in love. Living things grow and change. That is

precisely why we must WORK at building a healthy relationship.

Too often people fall in love, get married, and their relationship then proceeds to wither and die because it is assumed that everything after the altar is automatic.

Regardless of what the couple think (or imagine), their intimacy in the beginning is superficial. True intimacy grows only as a couple gets to know each other better. **(Leave on screen until next slide)** (ILL: Back to the team of horses...You must work them. A large part of training is just getting out and driving them) A new couple, regardless of chronological age, has simply not logged enough time in the harness to develop deep intimacy.

Marriage is a living developmental process that needs nurturing and care in order for it to grow and thrive. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**

Give your marriage proper attention and it will grow, neglect it and it will die. The choice is yours, invest some hard work and build a healthy relationship, or get a second job to pay the attorneys, and child support!

PROBLEM SOLVING

The old saying goes, “*There are only two things you can be sure of, death and taxes.*” Whenever you live with others, there is another thing you can be sure of: There will be problems from time to time.

(Place on screen one at a time)

1 Person + 1 Person = Conflict

1 Person in love + 1 Person in love = Conflict

Be assured, Conflict is a normal part of marriage. That's not just your marriage, that's everyone's marriage. How we deal with conflict, can make or break our relationships.

Often our ability to handle conflict is stifled by our very fragile egos. Even well established ego's become bruised in the course of a long-term relationships.

A bruised ego often results in a closed spirit. A closed spirit behaves itself in the following ways: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Anger...
- Speaking harsh words...
- A breakdown in trust...
- Being rude in public or private...
- Unwillingness to admit wrongdoing...
- Taking ones spouse for granted...
- Making jokes or sarcastic comments at the expense of ones spouse...
- Forcing ones spouse into doing something they are not comfortable doing...
- Believing ones needs are more important than the needs of ones partner...

There are three very necessary ingredients in developing good problem solving skills: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Overcome the tendency to jockey for control... Control is never what you thought it would be. You may get what you wanted, but I promise, you won't want what you get!
- Be a good listener... Listening involves more than hearing. Listening involves shutting out the peripheral noise and focusing on what ones spouse is saying. Listening is being able to read between the lines – hearing what is not being said is as important as what is being said.
- Being able to compromise... (Peacekeeper vs. Peacemaker) One should never give up core values, but much of what we are willing to die for has nothing to do with core values. Everyone needs to be able to give a little here and there. (Flexibility is the key) This is not Burger King you can't have it your way every time!

There should be a healthier approach to disagreements in marriage than what most couples employ, and there is. This approach begins with the notion that no one will emerge from the other side of a discussion having achieved the total implementation of their ideas as opposed to the ideas of the other person.

If you come into a discussion prepared to give some ground or admit to the possibility that you are not 100% right, the major barrier has been removed.

Many times when there are disagreements they stem from a lack of self-confidence on the part of one or both parties in the relationship. In this case we should be attempting to build confidence in our partner who is lacking in this area.

We should lovingly explain how they are capable of working through the difficulty. We should make our love, concern and support apparent without overwhelming them with a self help paradigm.

When both participants in a discussion enter with the firm commitment that they will emerge victorious from the battle, it is highly unlikely that anything significant at all will be accomplished.

When we become better at problem solving than we are at standing our ground in an argument, we have the opportunity to open the closed spirit of our partner. How do we go about opening the spirit of our spouse? [Sixteen rules to openness in a relationship: \(Place on screen one at a time\)](#)

- Work toward the happiness of our spouses...
- Say kind things that affirm our spouses...
Lovingly say what you mean but mean what you say.
- Value the opinion of our spouses...
- Offer trust before it is earned...
- Quickly admit when we are wrong...
- Do not embarrass our spouses in public...
- Place the comfort of ones spouse ahead of our own...
- Place the fulfillment of ones spouse ahead of our own...
- Attempt to win an agreement, not an argument...
- Attempt to hear what one is saying from the other person's point of view...

- Remember, if we lose your temper, we have lost our point...
- Spend as much time listening as we do making our case...
- Stay with the issue, don't drag in unrelated material and use it to devastate...
- Know how to tell the difference between facts and opinions... Opinions change, facts rarely change.
- Remember, victory by humiliation is no victory at all...
- Negotiate, don't exterminate... Proverbs 15:1 “*A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.*”

FORGIVENESS

As a Christian we recognize that we have experienced brokenness in relationship to God. The Gospel recounts God's actions to reconcile that broken relationship. ***"While we were yet in our sins Christ died for us..." "As far as the east is from the west, so far has He removed our transgressions..." "For God so loved the world that He gave..."***

Forgiveness is the action that God took which resulted in our redemption, restoration and reconciliation. **The act of forgiveness allows us to live beyond the power of the past. (Leave on screen until next slide)** (Man who said to the marriage counselor *"My wife gets all historical..."*)

We are not perfect, none of us! (Preacher who asked if anyone in the audience had ever known

a perfect person) Imperfection brings about brokenness in all of our relationships including our marriages. Brokenness (Sometimes referred to as baggage) produces the need for forgiveness. Forgiveness sets the guilty party as well as the innocent party free.

Forgiveness allows us to live for the future by allowing God to take the pain out of a past experience for us! (Joseph – Manasseh)

Since neither of the parties in a marriage is perfect, forgiveness and reconciliation are vitally important aspects of an enduring relationship. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**

A successful marriage is one where each party has developed a willingness to ask for and offer forgiveness.

SPIRITUALITY

Spirituality involves one's relationship to God and the expression of that relationship in everyday life. Spirituality includes: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Prayer...
- Family devotions...
- Church attendance...
- Tithing...
- Core values...
- Priorities...
- Common ground...

If we have not already done so we should start making history as a couple spiritually by implementing these things.

COMMUNICATION

The single most important factor in building deep interpersonal relationships in the family system is the presence of adequate skills in communication. When marriage or family systems function well, healthy and accurate communication is one of the most evident characteristics within such relationships.

Communication in marriage can be defined as the mutual exchange of thoughts and feelings between marriage partners. **(Leave on screen until next slide)** Please remember, just because

you said it does not mean you have communicated it!

The process of communication involves the use of the entire body: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Our ears to hear... Really hear – What is being said and what is not being said.
- Our voices to send messages... The right kind of messages – Carefully chosen words – In the right tones.
- Our hands... An open hand says we are open to discussion – A closed hand says we are closed to discussion and represents anger.
- Our faces... Be careful about facial expressions – A great exercise is to get in front of a mirror and practice saying what

you want to say and watch your facial expressions.

Our body language in general add to the messages we are attempting to send or close the other person off to the message we want to send. A tear rolling down the cheek speaks powerfully, as does the quivering hand or the rolling eyes.

Becoming an effective communicator involves being sensitive to how we use our body in the process, and how others are adding to the meaning of messages by the use of theirs. As we attempt to hone our communication skills we must be constantly aware of the tone of our voice as well as the degree of our attentiveness.

When we are attempting to share our feelings with our spouse, we will be far more successful if we use “*I*” messages rather than “*you*” messages. “*You make me feel*” sounds like an accusation. “*I feel*” is a much better method of sharing our feelings.

Attitude is perhaps the most important ingredient to successful communication. **(Leave on screen until next slide)** Statements like “*You shouldn’t feel that way,*” or “*How could you possibly feel that way,*” will most likely shut the other person down right away! A better way of addressing the issue is “*Why do you feel that way?*” or “*What have I done to cause you to feel that way?*”

This attitude will help our spouses feel free to share a problem with us in a way that will allow for a solution rather than a stalemate.

Communication is an active, dynamic, and skilled process. **(Leave on screen until next slide)** It is a process that we can become very good at if we are committed to growth in this area.

PERSONHOOD

Perhaps one of the greatest frustrations in marriage comes when one feels as if they are a possession rather than a person.

Commonplace statements in a counselor's office include:

- All I'm good for is bringing home a paycheck...
- Nobody really cares about my needs or problems...
- Everything I do for this family could be hired out - laundry, cooking, cleaning etc...
- If this family had a maid, I don't think they would miss me at all...
- I feel like just an object, a warm body when we have sex...

These statements express one disappointment:

"I have become a possession rather than a person in this relationship." In most relationships the turning of people into possessions is not intentional, it is more a matter of neglect. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**

When considering our spouses we should never forget we are not dealing with a possession we are dealing with a person. (People have likes, and dislikes - they also happen to have feelings as well) We must make sure our spouses feel valued as a very special person.

FINANCES

Some studies suggest that the number one cause of stress in first time marriages is money. This stress may be related to four basic issues: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- There isn't enough money... Sometimes there isn't enough money to meet the basic needs of the household. In which case the lifestyle must change, someone must take on an extra part time job, or someone has to find a better paying job.

- **Unrealistic expectations...** More times than not, the problem among young married couples is unrealistic expectations. (Don't forget, it took your parents 20 + years to accumulate what they have!)
- **Lack of proper management skills...** In this case there is enough money to meet needs, but the couple does not possess the management skills required to make financial ends meet. When money is not handled wisely disastrous consequences are to be expected. (If you will carefully attend the little money, the big money will take care of itself)
- **Different value systems...** Many marriage counselors will tell you the man should handle the finances and others would tell you the woman should handle the money. (Conservative vs. liberal) The conservative

money manager should manage the family finances. No matter who handles the finances each couple should sit down after the first of each month and review everything that came in and everything that went out. Accountability is a great thing. If one knows this meeting is going to happen it will cause each person to think twice before spending. This seems restrictive but marriage is a partnership and no one should be in the dark about the finances in a partnership. If neither person is good with money an independent person should be invited to assist in developing management skills.

SEXUALITY

We live in a society that is obsessed with sexual activity. This obsession has led us to believe

that sexual intercourse or associated physical sexual activity is synonymous with intimacy.

Couples feel great pressure to live up to the sexual call our society sends out. As a result, many feel frustrated or unsuccessful in marriage if sex is not all it's cracked up to be on TV or in other media forms. If we hold sexual activity at the center of our plan for intimacy in marriage we will no doubt be very disappointed at some point in the marriage. Sex between marriage partners should occupy a high priority but it cannot be the thing that everything else is judged by. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**

The sexual relationship between a husband and wife can be a wonderful expression of the intimacy. In a well-adjusted marriage each partner is at least as concerned about the other

persons needs and growth as we are about our own pleasure and satisfaction.

If our marriages are put together Biblically and properly, we will have a very healthy physical relationship with our spouses. (Lady at Fouke who brought a “*Better than sex*” cake to a pot-luck dinner)

There is nothing better than good sex and there is nothing worse than bad sex. Sex is more than a physical act it is an emotional and spiritual interaction between two people God intentionally put together. **(Leave on screen until next slide)**

With regard to our sexual relationships with our spouses we should remember the following

things taken from 1 Corinthians 13: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Love waits... Lust can't wait.
- Love shares... Selfishness refuses to sacrifice. Selfishness is the root of all sin.
- Love rejoices... Love rejoices at others success but insecurity can't recognize anyone but itself.
- Love is constantly honoring... Selfishness is constantly craves attention.
- Love comes from a heart overflowing with affection for God... Selfishness seeks its own best interest.

As married people we have a tremendous biblical responsibility toward our spouses in the arena of sexuality. God's first commandment to man was a sexual commandment, "*Be fruitful,*

and multiply, and replenish the earth."

(Genesis 1:28) The Bible say's Adam "***knew***" his wife.

God is the creator of sex but this culture has hijacked it, distorted it and perverted it. God brought Eve to Adam. The perversion was not so in the beginning. Genesis 2:25 "***They were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed."***

Three reasons they were not ashamed:

- A holy and righteous God, who commanded them to make love, introduced them...
- Their minds were not preconditioned to guilt...
- No other people were around to observe their intimate relations... (Keep everybody

out of your bedroom – Internet, pornography etc...)

A rule that must be honored in all marriages is that only what is enjoyable to both partners should be permitted. **(Leave o screen until next slide)** At the same time we must keep the needs of our spouse in mind and there are times we must bench our selfish, prudish ideas. Hebrews 13:4 *"Marriage is honorable in all, and the bed undefiled."*

Your body is not your own, you gave it to your partner at the altar when you said your marriage vows. 1 Corinthians 7:2-5 *"But since there is so much immorality, each man should have his own wife, and each woman her own husband. 3 The husband should fulfill his marital duty to his wife, and likewise the wife to her*

husband. 4 The wife's body does not belong to her alone but also to her husband. In the same way, the husband's body does not belong to him alone but also to his wife. 5 Do not deprive each other except by mutual consent and for a time, so that you may devote yourselves to prayer. Then come together again so that Satan will not tempt you because of your lack of self-control.” Four central principles taught in 1 Corinthians 7:2-5 concerning sex: **(Place on screen one at a time)**

- Both the husband and the wife have sexual needs and drives that should be fulfilled inside their marriage... If this does not happen the person who is withholding themselves from their partner is sinning against God, the marriage covenant and their mate.

- When one marries they forfeit control of their body to their partner... Both parties of a marriage relationship should seek opportunities to satisfy their mate. A healthy, exciting sexual relationship takes work and the individual that fails to work in this area is inviting disaster to wreck the marriage. To not do so is a sin against God, the marriage covenant and their mate.
- Both partners are forbidden to refuse to meet the sexual needs of their mate... This command is more than being available, this is a command to do everything physically, emotionally and sexually possible to keep the attention and affection of our spouse focused on us. (Alienation of affection) If this does not occur one should not be too shocked when one discovers their spouse has a wandering eye or has been unfaithful. If sex is not enjoyable (Lack of a sex drive –

Uncomfortable - Painful) to one of the marriage partners it is up to that person to seek every remedy possible. (Doctor – Marriage counselor etc...) Otherwise they leave themselves, their partner and the marriage itself at risk of temptation. To not do so is a sin against God, the marriage covenant and their mate.

- The act of sex within a marriage is approved by God and must be treated as such by all who commit to the marriage covenant... The Bible talks about “*Due benevolence*” inferring that people who enter into Holy marriage automatically assume a debt of lovemaking to their spouse. (Gallon jar full of beans) We should guard against being a deadbeat husband or wife in this area. To not do so is to sin against God, the marriage covenant and our mate.

WHAT LOVEMAKING MEANS TO A MAN

(Place on screen one at a time)

1) It satisfies his sex drive... (Now lets look at what lovemaking means to a woman! Ha!) It is generally agreed that the male in most species of living creatures has the stronger sex drive. So it's not a problem that your husband has a corner on!

Women have sex drive, but theirs is normally sporadic, whereas, a man's sex drive is almost continual.

2) It fulfills his manhood... A man usually possesses a stronger ego than a woman and it is a scientifically proven fact that his sex drive is

linked to his ego. This is not abnormal. It is completely normal.

A husband has a need to know that his wife thoroughly enjoys his lovemaking. The old Victorian nonsense that a "*nice lady*" doesn't act as if she enjoys sex conflicts with this.

A secure man becomes a better father, uses better judgment, and improves his capacity to love the entire family when his wife is meeting his sexual needs.

3) It enhances his ability to show his love for his wife... Because God has endowed a man with an intense sex drive and a conscience, the satisfactory release of that drive without

provoking his conscience will enhance his love for the person who makes that possible.

But only one person on earth should do that - his wife. If his wife is not fully engaged in meeting this need she is sinning against God, the marriage covenant and her husband. If the husband is not being the kind of man that causes his wife to want to meet his needs he is sinning against God, the marriage covenant and his wife.

4) It reduces friction in the home... I have counseled with women who refuse to make love to their husbands for long periods of time because they are mad that he treats them better after sex. Let me ask you a question. If when you performed certain responsibilities in your place of employment you were treated better by

the boss, and actually received promotions and raises because you went above and beyond the call of duty, would you not be happy to do a little extra? What about your husband?

5) It provides life's most exciting experience...

(Susan asked me one day, “*Why do you suppose God made sex?*” My response – “*Because he knew I would not have wanted to live if he hadn’t!*”) Sex is at the top of the list of things a man would rather do.

Men let me share the words of Jesus with you about your sex drive and thought life. Matthew 5:28, ***"I say unto you that whosoever, looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart."***

Vain imaginations can be very destructive to your marital relationship.

WHAT LOVEMAKING MEANS TO A WOMAN

(Place on screen one at a time)

1) It fulfills her womanhood... If a woman considers herself unsuccessful in bed, she will have a difficult time accepting her total womanhood.

A wife is more than a mother and a homemaker. She is also a sexual partner to her mate.

2) It reassures her of her husband's love... There are five kinds of love required by a woman.

- Companionship love. Few women enjoy solitude for long periods of time. Have you

noticed how few hermits and recluses are women?

- Compassionate love. A woman has a natural bedside manner, but only a few men display that kind of compassion.
- Romantic love. Women are romantics! She is looking for her knight in shining armor. For that reason she needs romance, flowers, music, soft lights, dinner out, and a host of other things. Romance is more than just making sure the door to the bedroom is locked! Some men think foreplay is telling their wife to brace herself! Ladies, I want you to make a top-ten-list of things you consider to be romantic acts then give it to your husband! (Do it right now – Give some time for this) He may need a little jump-starting! Just be careful not to kick-start

him! (Story about some beagles trying to jump-start a rabbit on a cold day)

Gentlemen, make sure the romantic adventure you have planned is for her best interest and not your own.

- [Affectionate love](#). Most women crave kisses of appreciation, which have nothing to do with sex. To women a tender touch, a warm embrace, and the closeness of the one they love is almost as enjoyable as the more intimate sexual contact. Song of Solomon 1:2 *"Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth: for thy love is better than wine, because of the savour of thy good ointments thy name is as ointment poured forth..."*
- [Passionate love](#). Impassioned love comes naturally to a man because of his stronger sex drive. Most women have to cultivate the

appetite for passionate loving, but they do have the capacity to learn. It is easier for a woman to express passionate love after the other four needs for love have been satisfied.

3) It satisfies her sex drive... Although a woman may not possess as strong or consistent a sex drive as a man, she does have a sex drive. If she doesn't there is either a physical, emotional or relational problem.

A woman does not seem so readily tempted to fantasize, as does her husband. However, she does have the capacity to remember romantically those exciting experiences of her past.

4) It relaxes her nervous system... Frigid women are nervous women. Note: not every nervous woman is frigid.

5) The ultimate experience... Sexual involvement and activity, like every other part of the relationship, will change and grow with time - whether one pays attention or not - this could be productive or counterproductive.

One should ask their partner questions to find out if the sexual experience is pleasurable or not? The best intimate sexual expression is a well-informed sexual expression. Hebrews 13:4
“Marriage is honorable, and the bed undefiled....”

Intimate sex recognizes a wealth of opportunities for intimate physical expression outside of the context of intercourse. Recreation (Doing a hobby together), a caring back-rub, a foot-rub, a quiet cup of coffee together, are all opportunities for intimate expression.

Keep, others out of your bedroom! Example - Alcohol, Drugs, Pornography, Magazines, Books, Violence, Fantasies, etc. The more purified our character, the more responsive our spouse.